Time off

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We offer our team unlimited time off, but with an expectation that you take *at least 25 days off a year*, including national holidays. This is to make sure that people can take time off flexibly while not feeling guilty about being on vacation.

The reason for this policy is that it's critical for PostHog that we hire people we can trust to be responsible with their time off - enough that they can recharge, but not so much that it means we don't get any work done. The People & Ops team will look into holiday usage occasionally to encourage people who haven't taken the minimum time off to do so. The 25 days is a minimum, not a guide.

As general guidance, we don't care about a few days here and there. If you are taking significantly more vacation time than most - for example, 40 days - we would be very surprised if you aren't causing a strain on the rest of your team as a result.

Permissionless time off

We care about your results, not how long you work.

You do not need to get approval for time off from your manager. Instead, we expect everyone to coordinate with their team to make sure that we're still able to move forwards in your absence. You should avoid things like:

- Having an entire Small Team off - this means we can't provide support to customers
- Having the only X people who can do some totally critical task at PostHog off - if this is unavoidable, try to make sure one of you can at least check in if something goes horribly wrong

How to book time off in PTO by Deel

Before you start, make sure that:

- You have authorized the PTO by Deel app in Slack to connect to your Google Calendar
- You have subscribed to the team time off calendar

If you don't do this, your holiday won't show up in the team time off calendar.

To book a day off:

- Book it on the PTO by Deel app in Slack. There are various types of time off you can select. It will be automatically approved and added to the team time off calendar (with the exception of longer term leave.) It will also be added to your manager's personal calendar.
- Do not book directly on deel.com as it does not sync with Slack, and the team will not know you are out. Yes, it is confusing that Deel have two separate systems here.

- There are four types of time off you can select
  - PTO - this will be the majority of the time for vacation or any other time off that doesn't fit below
  - Out Sick - this is when you're sick and will take time off unexpectedly
  - Parental Leave
  - Medical Leave - this is planned time off for you personally, on medical grounds - if it is a family member who requires support meaning you will be off, this is PTO.
- Block out your own personal GCal to show that you are out. This is because PTO by Deel *only* books in an all day event in your calendar to show that you are out. If you don't do this, automated meetings such as interviews or demos might still get booked into your cal.
- Set an out of office message on your email and have it point to someone else on the team, or hey@posthog.com. PTO by Deel will automatically set your Slack status to out of office and will autorespond to Slack messages.

> Please manually book in public holidays you plan to take off as well. We have team members working in countries all over the world, so it is not practical for us to book these all in on your behalf. Some people also prefer to work on certain days even if they're considered a public holiday in the country they are living in or visiting. In the Time Off by Deel app, you can use the Bulk Add by Region feature to quickly identify and add the public holidays you want off.

The same rules as above apply regardless of the holiday length and type. Sick leave and any other types of time off should also be booked in the same way.

How to cancel time off

If you decide to cancel your holiday, drop a message in #team-people-and-ops and a member of the team will cancel the holiday for you, as only admins can delete holidays.

Flexible working

We operate on a trust basis and we don't count hours or days worked. We trust everyone to manage their own time.

Whether you have an appointment with your doctor, school run with your kids, or you want to finish an hour early to meet friends or family - we don't mind and you don't need to tell us. Please just add it to your calendar and, if you are doing anything that could require you to be immediately available (ie support hero / or any customer-facing role), please make sure you have cover.

When you should have time off

You are sick

If you are sick, you don't need to work and you will be paid - the upper limit for paid sick leave for your country will be specified in your contract. This is assuming you need a day or two off, then just take them.

Please let your manager know if you need to take off due to illness as soon as you are able to and add it to PTO by Deel. You shouldn't pre-emptively book a bunch of days off sick, as you can't know how long you will actually be sick for and you may trigger the need for a doctor's note (see below). Just book the day or two off that you are sick then add more if you still feel unwell.

For extended periods of illness (5+ work days), or if you are going over the limit in your country/state, please speak to Fraser so we can work out a plan. In most countries, we will need a doctor's note from you.

If you have a medical condition you know will take you away from work regularly, please let Fraser know so we can work out accommodations with you and your manager.

Bereavements / Child loss

We do not define “closeness” and we won't ask about your relationship to the person or what they meant to you. Please just let us know up front how much time you would like to take.

Our bereavement policy also covers pregnancy and child loss for both parents, with no questions asked. Please take at least 2 weeks of paid leave.

If you need extended time for physical or mental health reasons, we will treat it as extended sick leave - just chat to Fraser.

Jury duty / voting / childcare disasters, aka 'life stuff'

There are lots of situations where life needs to come first. Please let it - just be communicative with your team and fit your work around it as you need. We trust you will do the right thing here.

If you are summonsed for jury duty, please let Fraser know right away - we can often get an exception granted if we have enough notice.

Parental leave

Parental leave is exceptional as it needs to be significantly longer than a typical vacation. Anyone at PostHog, regardless of gender, is able to take parental leave, and regardless of whether you've become a parent through childbirth or adoption.

This table explains the amount of paid time off, depending on how long you've been at PostHog

Time at posthog	maternity leave	paternity leave
under 6 months	3 weeks	2 - 3 weeks
6 - 12 months	12 weeks	2 - 3 weeks
over 12 months	up to 24 weeks	6 weeks